Muhammad Talal Ahmed

SOC Analyst | SIEM · Wazuh · Incident Response · Python

mail@ta1al.com | Pakistan | ta1al.com | linkedin.com/in/Ta1al | github.com/Ta1al

CompTIA Security+ certified Computer Science graduate (CGPA 3.79, Bronze Medal) with hands-on SOC experience from two assessed internship programmes. Deploys and tunes Wazuh, writes detection rules, and hunts through endpoint, firewall, and Windows event telemetry. Publishes public writeups on forensics, AI security, and cloud attack paths.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations	Wazuh, SIEM, SOAR, n8n, ELK, Splunk, alert triage, incident response, detection rules, decoders, FIM, Sysmon
Threat Hunting & DFIR	MITRE ATT&CK, IOC/IOA analysis, malware triage, Binary Ninja, ANY.RUN, VirusTotal, Autopsy, KAPE, phishing analysis
Network & Cloud	pfSense, firewall policy, segmentation, syslog-ng, TCP/IP, VLANs, Wireshark, PCAP analysis, AWS and Azure fundamentals
Systems & Automation	Ubuntu Server, Linux, Bash, systemd, Windows 10/11, VMware, Docker, Python, SQL, TypeScript
Also:	FastAPI, PostgreSQL, LangGraph, RAG, Scikit-learn, Git, Odoo ERP, GRC risk assessment

EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Intern — SecureNetics 07/2026 – 10/2026

SOC Internship Programme · Team Epsilon · 8 assessed assignments

- Completed an eight-week SOC programme, delivering an assessed report each week across log analysis, Wazuh deployment, threat hunting, DFIR, and SOC operations.
- Wrote a custom correlation rule for repeated SSH failures from one source IP, then analysed how IP rotation, slow brute force, and spraying would evade it.

SOC Analyst Intern — ITSOLERA PVT LTD 01/2026 – 04/2026

SOC Internship Programme · Team Lambda · 6 assessed tasks

- Integrated a software firewall with Wazuh and wrote rules to block country traffic, restrict access to specified sites, and enforce administrator privileges, testing each in a home lab.
- Built a Wazuh-to-n8n workflow that parses, filters, and forwards alerts, delivering only actionable events instead of raw dashboard noise.
- Executed malware behind pfSense in an isolated VM and produced an incident response plan grounded in the detection and log evidence observed.

IT Intern — Jauharabad Sugar Mills Pvt Ltd 07/2025 – 09/2025

- Provided tier-1 support for Windows, hardware, and network faults in a production facility, and validated roughly 9,200 QR-coded records.

LABS & CASE STUDIES

Home SOC Lab — Detection, Telemetry & Automation Wazuh, Sysmon, pfSense, syslog-ng, n8n

- Built a lab combining Wazuh, a Sysmon-instrumented Windows endpoint, and pfSense log forwarding, then ran a controlled malware exercise: Wazuh raised the file-drop and abnormal-shell rules while pfSense denied outbound 443.

Wazuh Detection Engineering & Threat Hunt Ubuntu Server, VMware, MITRE ATT&CK

- Triaged ten live alerts across authentication, SSH, privilege escalation, and FIM, and documented five built-in rules with their trigger conditions and required analyst action.
- Reconstructed a multi-stage intrusion across a jumphost, web server, and workstation, mapping execution and ingress-tool-transfer behaviour to ATT&CK T1059.001 and T1105.

WRITING & OPEN SOURCE

Published 16 TryHackMe writeups and four longer posts at ta1al.com/blog — Windows forensics, AI security and prompt injection, AWS/Azure paths, web exploitation, OSINT.

40+ public repositories at github.com/Ta1al across TypeScript, Python, and Astro, including a local-LLM bot that flags identifying messages.

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science — Sargodha University 2022 – 2026

CGPA 3.79 (Bronze Medal) · President, Programming Society

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ (Jul 2026) · Google Cybersecurity Professional · IBM Cybersecurity Specialization · TryHackMe SOC L1

National Skills Competency Test — Rank 65 nationwide (Top 0.2%)